

mining genetic affiliation of the Xiong-nu language: Turks could have just borrowed it from Xiong-nu.

True to his principle of resegmenting Xiong-nu poem, Bazin gets rid of the first syllable in 𪛗𪛗𪛗 = *Ko-thok-tang "to capture", and interprets remaining *thok-tang as Old Turkic tut- "prendre, saisir" with the following suffix -qaŋ. This, of course, implies a metathesis of /k/ and /t/ in the Xiong-nu original, that Bazin attributes to Chinese notation (1948: 212). Why Chinese would be guilty of such misbehaviour remains unclear: in the fourth century C.E. the Chinese language had both final -t and -k. Another problem that faces Bazin here is that Old Turkic does not have second person plural imperative -qaŋ, but only -aŋ. Bazin tries to appeal to optative-subjunctive -qa or -qay and to possible elision of -q- to save his etymology, but this further makes his explanation even more speculative. The first syllable *Ko, that was cut off to get Old Turkic *tut- "catch, take" is interpreted as Turkic accusative in -γ/-g, but note that it is transcribed in Chinese in a quite different way than after the alleged word *sü* "army." To be more exact, as it was already pointed out above, there is no evidence for the accusative in the first line at all.

The most grave misanalysis occurs in the first line. Since Bazin already cut off the character 支 from the word 秀支 "army" in order to get Old Turkic *sü-g* "army-acc.", as was already discussed above, he has to explain somehow the remaining characters 支替戾岡. He reads the characters 支替 as /t'iæg t-ieɪ/, which he further interprets as Old Turkic *täg-* "to attack" + *-ti*, past tense marker (1948: 215). Characters 戾岡 are read as /liəd kaŋ/, and interpreted as Old Turkic *id-* "send", and -qaŋ (Bazin 1948: 215), a non-existent suffix of the second person plural imperative that has already been discussed above. Unfortunately for Bazin, both his readings and interpretations are plagued by grave problems. First, the initial of the character 支 was not /t'/ at this time, but *k-, as amply evidenced by usage of 支 in Old Korean writing for /ki/ or /ke/ and in Old Japanese *man'yōgana* for /kyi/. Second, it is completely incomprehensible how 戾 /re(ts)/ (Bazin's /liəd/) can stand for Old Turkic *id-*: the final consonant there was probably lost in the Han period, and initial liquid cannot be simply ignored. Third, the Chinese translation given by Futo Cheng does not mention either "attacking" or "sending" as found in Bazin's